

ZOLVE INTERNSHIP - CASE STUDY

1. GETTING IN - ONBOARDING

My introduction to Zolve started on Handshake when I applied for the internship position. Later the same day I got a call from Kavya who walked me through the process. She told me about the case study process and helped me with the credit card application process.

I first tried to apply on zolve.com directly but the experience was not very good because the page kept loading without a clear reason and I was not sure if it was a website glitch or if there was an issue from my side. Then Kavya guided me to download the app on my mobile and proceed. So I went ahead and did the same. Once I downloaded the app, I logged in with my University's mail id, clicked on 'Apply now' for credit card and began filling in my details.

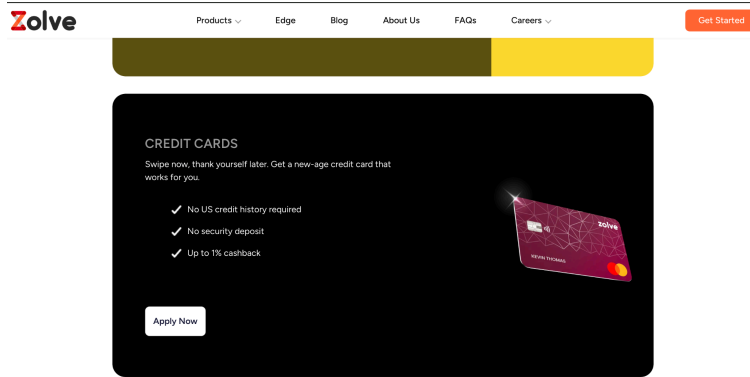
It started with verifying my face and document upload flow asked for my passport, visa, bank statement (address proof), and I-20. The step itself was straightforward and did not cause any confusion. I was then presented with 3 card options, where I chose Classic as it has no annual fee. My card was approved during the call and I got my virtual card which can also be added on Apple pay.

What worked: the app flow was clean after I found my footing, the three-card selection was clear, and approval was fast. But I'm not sure how long it would take for the card to get approved and what other issues would have come if Kavya was not on call with me. That is something to think about. Then, I uploaded my OPT I20 which was not accepted and kept loading again. Kavya then suggested that I refresh the app and come back. There was a progress tracker where I can resume from where I left off, which is also a good thing I noticed.

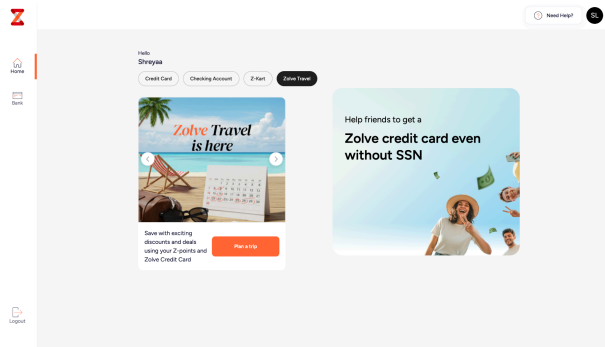
What broke: As a first time user the website was not very user friendly due to the loading issue I mentioned above. Another issue was that when the website was not responding, some people may drop the process and find it frustrating. Without the help from a person like Kavya, it would have been a little difficult to navigate.

For more people to onboard, more awareness about the product has to be created like recruiting part time interns from major universities and making them market the idea of this. Also referral codes can be provided and onboarding with the referral code can come with special cashbacks.

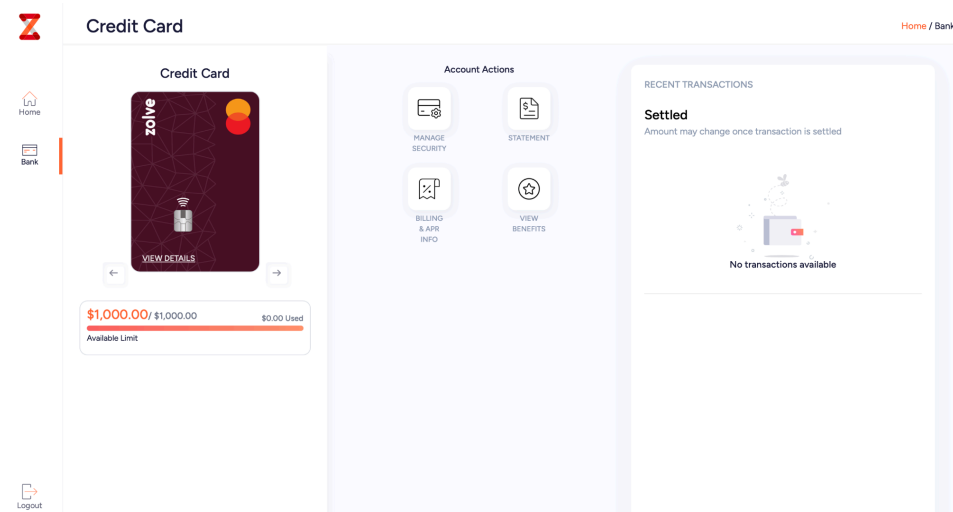
And what I think would make the biggest impact is marketing the credit card with Zkart because the two major unique things about Zolve is Zkart and credit card without SSN for international students and professionals. When I browse about this in general there is no awareness about Zkart.

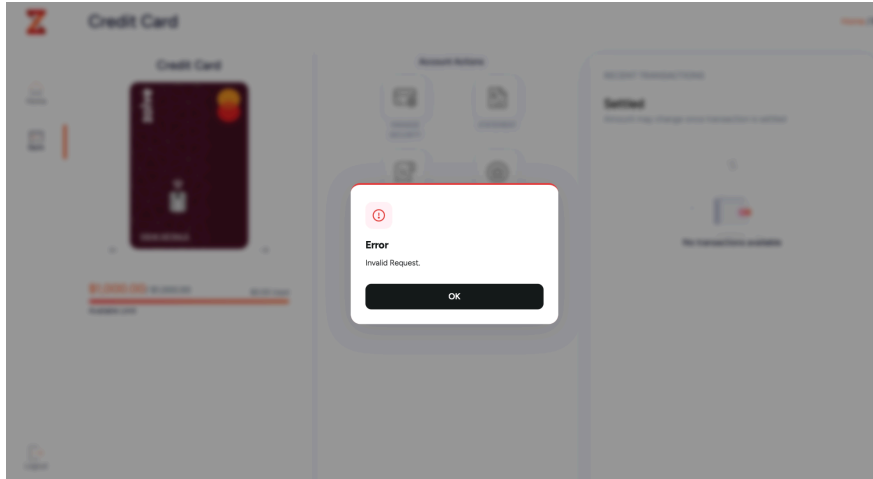


After logging in, the Zolve travel from the homepage redirected me to the credit card section with no explanation. Either the feature isn't live yet and the tab should be hidden, or there should be a clear "coming soon" state instead of a silent redirect.



Another issue I noticed was when I was looking into my details in the bank section, I tried to click the view details and an error message popped up and redirected to the homepage. I am not sure if it is because I do not have a physical card or if it is a technical issue but this is something I noticed.



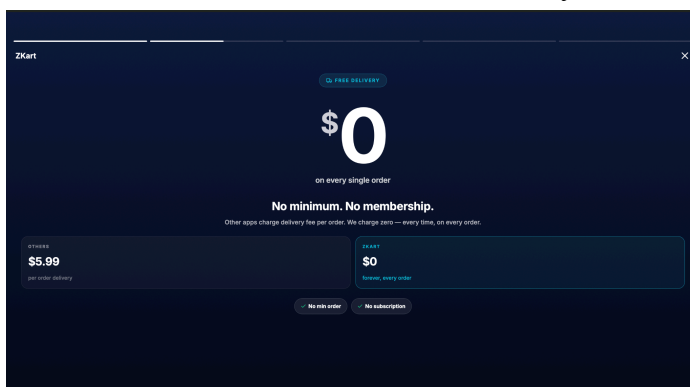


2. THE ZKART EXPERIENCE

Zkart is easy to find. I was able to find it right after opening the app and logging in to the website. The homepage is well-organized: a search bar at the top, popular categories (Electronics, Fragrances, Beauty, Snacks, Jerseys, Gaming, Sneakers, Health), a Trending section, and a Subscriptions row featuring Claude, ChatGPT Plus, Spotify, Netflix, and LinkedIn Premium.

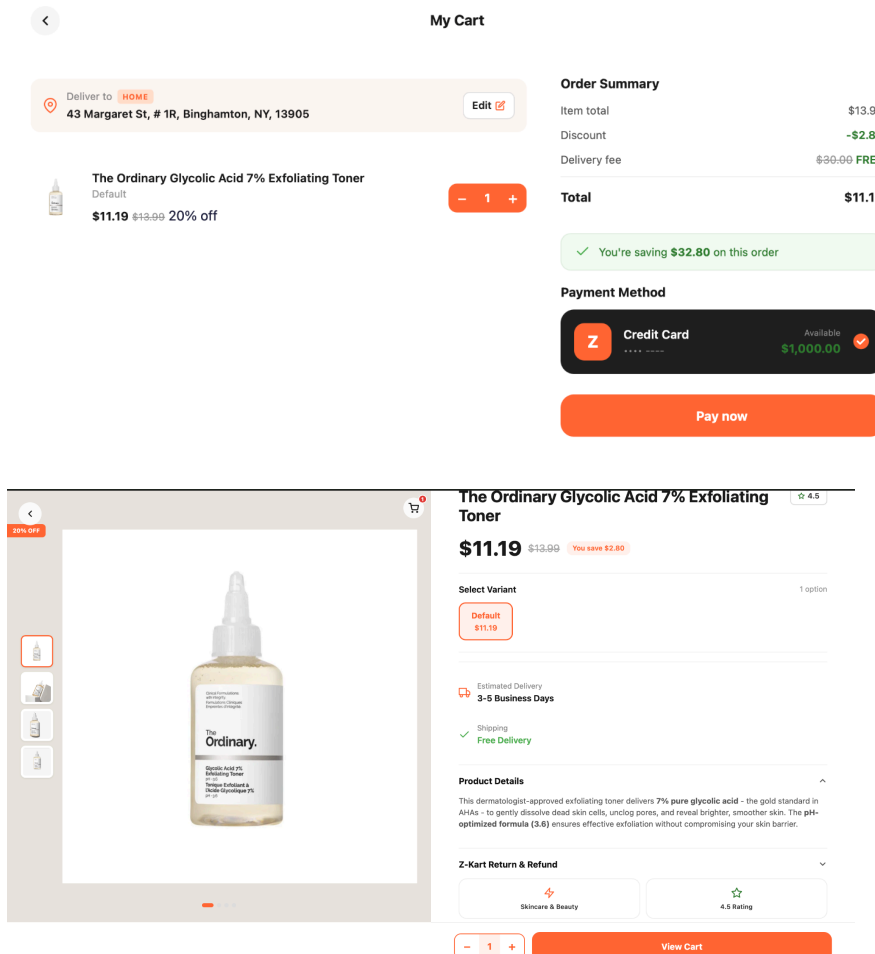
I added The Ordinary Glycolic Acid 7% Exfoliating Toner to my cart. At \$11.19 (20% off from \$13.99), with free delivery, the cart showed I was saving \$32.80 on the order. The checkout screen was clean and delivery address pre-filled, Zolve credit card auto-selected as payment method with the available limit shown (\$1,000.00). One tap to "Pay now." There was nothing technically broken in this flow.

What I felt was the promotions that appear when the orange star icon on top left is clicked can be displayed somewhere on Zkart's homepage (maybe as a banner) itself. This will attract the customers more as many won't bother clicking the icon.



The other gap was that the product page lacked reviews. Usually when I buy anything online, I will first go through the reviews section where people write about their opinion and post pictures of the product they received. In a new platform, the absence of reviews

will seem a bit off. And the other gap I found was the delivery fee was \$0 but the original fee displayed was \$30. Any huge platform will have a delivery fee in the range \$5-\$10 and a \$30 delivery fee coming down to \$0 seems too good to be true.



WOULD I COME BACK?

To be honest, if there are more user reviews and if the product that arrives is an original one, I would come back. There should be more promotional banners (like "you're one order away from your first ZKart save") that are attractive and make people want to come back.

What would bring me back without being reminded is Personalization. Right now, it shows the same homepage to everyone and does not have a search history or recommendations based on what I searched. If it displays deals based on what I already browsed, it would remind me to come back as students are price sensitive and will always remember deals on products they actually want.

Since Zkart is student specific, expense tracker or savings tracking systems can be added which will personalize the experience even more.

Also, I saw a lot of Indian products on Zkart but international students are from all around the world and the whole experience felt more 'Indian international student specific'. More global products can be added which will in turn bring in students from a lot of different nationalities.

If I had to double daily orders in 30 days, I would focus more on product recommendations and deals after every checkout and search history (for instance, 'you just saved X, you may also like').